



Profile

Personal Information

Name Njuguna, Martha *Wangechi*
Preferred Name Martha
Sex, Birthdate Male, 06/09/2001

Contact Details

Email, Phone marthanjuguna01@gmail.com, +254.787835351, Mobile, +254.791835351, Mobile
Permanent Address 8th Floor Equity Centre, Upper Hill P.O Box 75104 Nairobi, 00200, KEN

Demographics

Military Status None
Hispanic or Latino No
Race **Black or African American** (Africa)

Language

English First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Gikuyu Speak, Spoken at Home

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status Other (Non-US)
Birthplace Nairobi, Kenya (0 Years US, 18 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships Kenya
Current US Visa None
Intended US Visa F-1 Student

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested Yes, Signed: MARTHA WANGECHI NJUGUNA
I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor, financial aid officer, or community leader

Family

Household

Parents Married
Home Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name Mr. Gitutu Peter N Wangechi
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone njugunagpn@gmail.com, +254.771645671, Mobile
Address a different address
P.O. Box 18432 Nairobi, 00100, KEN
Occupation Accountant or actuary, Unemployed
Education Graduated from college/university
Bachelors (1996), **University of Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN**

Parent 2

Mother

Name Mrs. Judie G Kamau
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone judie.kamau@gmail.com, +254.722864581, Mobile
Address a different address
P.O. Box 18432 00100 Nairobi, Nairobi, 00100, KEN
Occupation Other, Self-Employed
Education Graduated from college/university
Bachelors (2019), **Africa International University, KEN**

Siblings

1. Nathan M Njuguna, Age 12, Brother, Some grade/primary school
2. Matthew K Njuguna, Age 6, Brother, None

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

Loreto High School Limuru, Private Bag 00217, Limuru, KEN, Public (02/2015 - 11/2018)

Counselor Mr. Cyrus Wachira, Dean of Studies
Email, Phone academics@loretolimuru.co.ke, +254.720347528
Boarding School Yes: Living at School
Progression Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date 11/2018

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 2 / 271, Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)
English - (REG)	English - (REG)	English - (REG)
Kiswahili - (REG)	Kiswahili - (REG)	Kiswahili - (REG)
Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)
Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)
Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)
Geography - (REG)	Geography - (REG)	Geography - (REG)
Christian Religious Education - (REG)	Christian Religious Education - (REG)	Christian Religious Education - (REG)

Honors

Bronze Medal in Physics, National Science and Mathematics Olympiad	National	12
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First Runner's Up in the category 'Ecological and Biological Sciences' 2018 Young Scientists Kenya	National	12
Overall First Position in Geography, National Humanities Contest	National	12
Second Place, 2016 Safaricom Technovation Challenge	State/Regional	10
First Position project, Kenya Science and Engineering Fair, Regional Level	State/Regional	11

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	Equity Leadership Program
Counselor	Ms. Eva Muriuki
Email, Phone	eva.muriuki@equitybank.co.ke, +254.763026061

Future Plans

Computer programmer or analyst, Doctorate

Testing

ACT

Composite	34	10/12/2019
English	34	10/12/2019
Math	34	10/12/2019
Reading	33	10/12/2019
Science	35	10/12/2019
Writing	8	10/12/2019
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
ACT Plus Writing Test	Yes	

SAT Subject Tests

Chemistry	11/2019
Math Level 1	11/2019
Math Level 2	11/2019

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
English	A-	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Biology	B+	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Geography	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Christian Religious Education	A-	11/2018, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Science/Math

10, 11, 12	Chairlady, Loreto High School Limuru Science Club
School	Won First Runner's Up prize at the 2018 Young Scientists Kenya Competition; Spearheaded the release of the school's first club magazine (The Atom)
5 hr/wk, 21 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11	Sergeant Admin. St. John Ambulance Movement
Year	Coordinated & oversaw community service at Tigoni District Hospital; Inspired & led cadets to win 1st Place at 2016 Nat. First Aid & Drill Competitions
10 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr	
Continue	

Debate/Speech

11, 12	Secretary, Debate Club
School	In depth analysis of research material to get strong debating points; Supervised weekly debates among club members and with other schools
3 hr/wk, 6 wk/yr	
Continue	

Computer/Technology

10	Team Leader, 2016 Technovation Challenge
School	Oversaw the development of a mobile app that won second place in our region; Pioneered the launch of Computer Club in my school in 2016
6 hr/wk, 4 wk/yr	
Continue	

Religious

11, 12	Treasurer, Christian Union
School	Revolutionized the organization of Sunday Services in school; Ensured accountability in management of the society's funds for charity work
3 hr/wk, 37 wk/yr	
Continue	

Theater/Drama

11	Treasurer, Drama Club
School	Managed the club's finances in regards to expenditure during club outings; Led the team to the Nat. Drama Festivals up to the Regional Level
7 hr/wk, 6 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

11, 12, PG	Sunday School Coordinator
Year	Teaching children aged 4-7 Bible teachings every Sunday; Organized a fundraiser for a Sunday School projector early this year.
3 hr/wk, 52 wk/yr	
Continue	

Internship

PG	Relationship Officer, Equity Bank Kenya
Year	Maximized customer satisfaction at the customer service desk; Carried out cash transactions and handled large volumes of cash
65 hr/wk, 28 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

PG	Co-Founder, Baraka Initiative
Year	Initiating the settlement of homeless children in children's homes; Securing funding from well-wishers for the underprivileged in my village
7 hr/wk, 32 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

PG	Remedial Tutor at Rungiri Primary School
Year	Tutoring pupils during weekends due to shortage of teachers; Deciphered pupils' weaknesses & implemented effective tutoring methods to improve grades
4 hr/wk, 25 wk/yr	
Continue	

Writing

Personal Essay

Discuss an accomplishment, event, or realization that sparked a period of personal growth and a new understanding of yourself or others.

It was the strangest habit. *Mama* and *Baba* had told me. Teacher Mary had told me. She watched distastefully as I tied the shoelace knot at the front and then again behind my ankle.

"That's not the way to tie your shoelaces, Wangechi," Teacher Mary castigated.

I remained silent, struggling to find words to express why I insisted on tying my laces behind my ankles. Could she possibly understand my exasperation each time someone stepped on my heel and my shoe came off? It happened every day. As we played in the dry, dusty field. As we walked home in the scorching afternoon heat. Each time someone stepped on my shoe from behind, I would burst out in anger, tears almost spilling from my eyes as I furiously wore my shoe again.

That is, until I realized I could tie my laces behind my ankles, and avoid the vexation. My parents wondered who had taught me to tie my laces like that. After trying unsuccessfully to get me to start tying them normally, they resigned themselves to the fact that I wouldn't let go of the habit.

A decade later, I have come to the realization that this habit ran deeper than my irritation at having to sit and wear my shoes again. It was a fear of having my boat rocked. As I grew up, it became apparent that I liked calm waters. I liked it when situations remained as they were. I resented change.

The news that *Mama* was expecting another baby came suddenly. I couldn't understand why. Everything was fine as it was, and I knew that an addition to the family would change things. Resentment and dread were the only emotions I felt. I was anxious about the changes that would come with an addition to the family. I was comfortable with life as it was, and this drastic change felt like my shoe was being stepped on from the back and was coming off. Except, in this case, I was unable to rewear my shoe and tie the laces around my ankles. I struggled with coming to terms with the reality that life would stop being as I had gotten accustomed to.

This reality, however, turned out to be more beautiful than I could ever imagine. When I held my little brother for the first time and looked into his half-shut eyes, I knew that this 'addition' would be a blessing in many ways. Suddenly, I didn't mind that I would have to sit down and wear my shoes after having them stepped on from the back. This time, in fact, I wouldn't tie my shoelaces behind my ankles so as to keep my shoe exactly as it was. I would not try to prevent this 'addition' from rocking my boat. Because it had. And I loved it.

Today, little Matthew is such an important part of my life that I can hardly imagine what life would be without his constant chatter and joyful spirit. I love the change he brought in my life. I think about it every time I stop working on my assignment to help him write the letters of the alphabet. Every time I leave my dinner to warm him a glass of milk.

Every single time is a reminder of the progress I have made in learning to embrace change and the new emotions, lessons and ideas it exposes one to. I know now that change is the law of life, and those who look only to the past and the present are certain to miss the future. I have learnt to embrace change in other aspects of my life. And even though I still tie my shoelaces behind my ankles, I am no longer anxious about the prospect of my shoes being stepped on from the back because I know that I can always wear them and continue walking.

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

Upon graduating, I spent my free time volunteering at Angel's Center for Abandoned Children. I volunteered thrice a week, and spent time playing with the children. I helped clean up around the home during their afternoon naps.

I have also been a part of my church's Sunday School department, actively assisting with teaching the children. I have participated in activities like mission work and hiking. I like hiking, and I climbed Elephant Hill and the Aberdare Ranges in readiness to climb Mt. Kenya early next year.

I spent most of my gap year interning at Equity Bank as part of the Equity Leadership Program. I worked at Kimathi Branch for seven months, where I did an average of 150 cash transactions daily, handled large amounts of cash and addressed customer complaints and disputes.

In May, my neighbors and I successfully co-founded the Baraka Initiative, which raises funds to support the underprivileged in our village and finds homes for homeless children. I also spent my Saturday afternoons tutoring pupils at a local primary school due to a shortage of teachers.

Following my interest in programming, I have been learning how to code. I have attended tech-related events such as GDG DevFest, Nairobi Tech Week, Nairobi and SheHacks 2019.

I participated in several charity marathons this year such as the Mater Heart Run, Beyond Zero and Standard Chartered marathons.

At home, I help my mother with household chores and take care of my younger brothers when my parents are away.

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Columbia University Questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2020
Admission plan	Early Decision
Early Decision Agreement	Yes, I have read and understand my rights and responsibilities under the Early Decision Process. I wish to be considered as an Early Decision candidate at Columbia University. MARTHA WANGECHI NJUGUNA
Certify authenticity of application materials	Yes, I have read and understand this statement.
Financial aid	Yes
School Specific Fee Waivers	No, I do not qualify for one of Columbia's fee waivers
Are you eligible for and/or enrolled in the Federal Free and Reduced Lunch Program (FRLP)?	No

More Information

Portfolio	No
Have you been approved to receive Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA) status?	No

Academics

College or Engineering	Columbia Engineering
First intended Area of Study	Computer Science
Second Intended Area of Study	Electrical Engineering
Third Intended Area of Study	Computer Engineering

Activities

Activity 1	Science and Engineering
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Activity 2	Entrepreneurship
Activity 3	Foreign Language

Contacts

Previously applied	No
Contact 1	Regional presentation with other colleges
If you wish to be contacted via mobile phone, please provide your phone number. Contact methods may include phone calls generated from an automated telephone dialing system or text messaging.	I consent to be contacted by Columbia University at the mobile phone number provided below.
Mobile	+254.787835351
What are your pronouns in use? (optional)	she,her

Family

Sibling applied	No
Relatives attended member	No
Relative employed at member	No
Household Size	6

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here:
<http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.